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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-U GP (HONOURS)REGULAR EXAMINATION MARCH 2026
FOURTH SEMESTER
DISCIPLINE SPECIFIC ELECTIVE(DSE) - MG4DSEPSY201- COMMUNITY
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration :2 hours. **Maximum marks** :**70**

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Skill (S), Interest (I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

PART A
MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS
Answer all questions
Each question carries 2 marks

1. The idea of community revival challenges which modern tendency most strongly?

Answer:c) Individualism

2. Which of the following reflects the action-oriented nature of Community Psychology?

Answer:c) Designing community intervention programs

3. Failure to provide quality early childhood education may result in:

Answer:b) Long-term learning gaps and social inequality

4. Planned change differs from spontaneous change because it is:

Answer:a) Goal-oriented and systematically implemented

5. Cultural diversity in school requires teachers to:

Answer:d) Adopt culturally responsive pedagogy

6. The word community is derived from the Latin word:

Answer: a) communitas

7. The four broad principles guiding community research emphasize:

Answer: a) Prevention, participation, and social justice

8. Bullying in schools is considered a social issue because it:

Answer: a) Affects emotional and social development

9. A consultant typically works by:

Answer: b) Advising and supporting problem-solving efforts

10. Evaluating the impact of a new education policy requires:

Answer: c) Systematic research and critical analysis

11. According to social disorganization theory, crime is more likely to occur in communities with:

Answer: a) Weak social institutions and instability

12. Which of the following is NOT a factor contributing to the emergence of Community Psychology?

Answer:d) Psychoanalytic theory dominance

13. Substance abuse in a community is best addressed through:

Answer: c) Preventive and rehabilitative intervention

14. One major advantage of networking is:

Answer:c) Better coordination of services

15. Person–environment interaction in community psychology refers to:

Answer:a) Understanding how people and environments influence each other

Part B: Short Essay
Answer any 4 questions
Each question carries 10 marks

16. Discuss the structural features of rural society and analyse how they sustain traditional community life.

Rural society refers to communities located in villages where life is closely connected with nature, agriculture, and traditional social systems. These societies have unique structural features that strongly influence community life.
Proximity and Stability: Traditional rural life is built on "proximity, continuity and stability," which act as a crucible for community ties.
Multiplex Relationships:Residents experience "linked multiple relationships" (multiplexity) where the same people are encountered in various roles (e.g., neighbor, workmate, fellow

worshiper).

Mechanical Solidarity:Rural villages often display "mechanical solidarity," where similarity in backgrounds and "common ways of thinking and feeling" create a dense social web.

Organic Connection to Place: The village is often viewed as an "organic" context, slow-growing and in harmony with its agricultural environment, providing a common purpose.

Rural social structure plays a crucial role in maintaining traditional community life, though gradual change is necessary to balance tradition with development.

17. Discuss the importance of training in Community Psychology. What competencies are required for effective community practice?

Community psychology focuses on promoting well-being through social change and community-based interventions. Proper training is essential for effective practice.

Importance of Training:

Professionalization: community work has shifted from marginal, voluntary activity to a "professionalized" field and a "significant industry".

Growing Field of Employment:There is an expanding demand for community workers, facilitators, and experts to manage "regeneration, participation and intervention" .

Technical Requirements: Modern community practice requires "monitoring and evaluation" as key components of project work to meet the performance criteria and targets set by funding bodies.

Required Competencies:

Analytical Skills: Practitioners must be able to conduct "local needs assessments, community audits and village appraisals" and construct "community profiles".

Research Adaptation: Effective practice involves adapting social scientific techniques (quantitative and qualitative) so they can be understood and utilized by "ordinary people" within the community.

Facilitation and Leadership:Professionals act as "consultants, facilitators, and intermediaries" who lead divided communities toward cooperation and conflict resolution.

Capacity-Building:A core competency is the ability to enable "capacity-building measures" that empower community members to take ownership of local processes and tackle their own priorities.

Training equips community psychologists with essential competencies to bring meaningful and sustainable social change.

18. Examine the limitations of Western measures of control when applied to non-Western collectivistic communities.

Western psychological concepts are largely based on individualism, which may not suit collectivistic societies like India.

Individualism vs. Responsibilities: Western models often emphasize individual "rights," whereas collectivistic communities may prioritize "responsibilities" and the "moral voice" of the group to enforce behavior.

Mislabeling Disorganization: Outside observers often view dense, complex urban or poor areas as "disorganized," when they actually possess a well-defined internal social order (e.g., "ordered segmentation") invisible to outsiders.

Informal vs. Formal Controls: Western measures often rely on bureaucratic agencies, while collectivistic communities use informal sanctions like "gentle chastisement," gossip, or even exclusion to maintain order.
Western models need cultural adaptation to be effective in non-Western collectivistic societies

19. Compare information dissemination and community education. Highlight their similarities and differences.

Both information dissemination and community education are methods used to create awareness and promote social development.

Information Dissemination:

Abstract Systems: In modern, "disembedded" social relations, people rely on "abstract systems of information" rather than personal knowledge .

Top-Down Control: It is often a "top-down" tool used by "urban managers" or the state to frame the parameters of community life or to "label" specific areas and groups (e.g., stigmatized "problem areas") .

Functional Purpose: It serves to render community "calculable" for public administration and governance .

Community Education:

Empowerment Focus: Education is defined as "helping people to work together... to grow in confidence and competence" to solve their own problems .

Participatory Methods: It involves "interactive planning exercises" and "surveys" that enable the views of all sections of a community to be integrated .

Self-Determination:Unlike simple dissemination, education aims for "self-determination" and "capacity-building".

Similarities and Differences:

Similarities:Both are used as "tools for intervention" to manage community change and regeneration. Both utilize research-based toolkits to assess local conditions.

Differences:Information dissemination is often more passive or regulatory, sometimes being "done to" communities to manage conflict . **Community education** is more "active" and "bottom-up," focusing on "giving the weak a voice" and enabling them to mobilize collective power .

Both methods are important, but community education leads to more sustainable change.

20. Discuss the relationship between social processes such as poverty, unemployment, and marginalization and the need for human services.

Social processes like poverty, unemployment, and marginalization negatively affect individuals and communities.

Industrial Collapse: Economic restructuring has removed "organized production" from many communities, leading to widespread unemployment and the loss of "industrial culture".

Concentrated Deprivation: These social processes create "wild zones" or estates that become "dumping grounds" for "problem people," where community control over the streets is lost .

Shift to Consumption:As production vanishes, the need for human services shifts toward "collective consumption"—the provision of housing, health, and welfare by the state to reproduce the workforce.

Human services are essential to address the negative effects of social problems and promote well-being.

21. Examine how the concept of control differs between urban individualistic societies and rural collectivistic communities.

Social control refers to mechanisms that regulate behavior in society.
Urban Individualism: Control is often formal and bureaucratic . Relationships are "anonymous" and "transitory," leading individuals to cultivate "privacy" and rely on abstract systems of information rather than personal trust .
Rural Collectivism: Control is deeply personal and rooted in "shared knowledge" . The "community moral voice" exerts pressure to conform.
Surveillance: In rural settings, "everybody knows everybody else's business," allowing for continuous informal cementing of norms. In urban settings, control might involve "gated communities" or "systems of surveillance" to regulate access.
Both systems have strengths and limitations; a balance between formal and informal control is ideal.